

Getting started with Microsoft 365 Copilot Premium

A practical guide to getting real value from Copilot Premium in your first week. What it is, where to find it, and the prompts worth knowing.

For C-suite and executive leaders new to Copilot

From Michael Goad, Copilot Solution Engineer, Microsoft

Scope Copilot Chat, Outlook, Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Teams

You didn't move into leadership to spend your day catching up on email. Copilot Premium takes the reading, drafting, and prep so your attention goes back to the decisions only you can make.

Copilot does the catch-up. You make the calls.

The playbook

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Why this matters

Most of your day goes to keeping up. This is about getting that time back.

Your inbox, your meetings, and your documents already hold more than you can read. Copilot Premium does the reading, drafting, and prep so your time goes to judgment, direction, and the people who need you. It works inside the Microsoft 365 apps you already use, more like a chief of staff than a chatbot.

Premium matters because it works from your actual work, not the public web. It reads across your email, meetings, documents, and calendar, all inside your company's security. That is the difference between a tool that sounds smart and one that knows what is going on.

What Premium unlocks

It knows your work

Ask about a thread, a customer, a project, or a document by name and Copilot reads across your Microsoft 365 content to answer.

It works where you work

Built into Outlook, Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Teams, and a single Copilot Chat front door. No new tool to learn.

It sounds like you

Set it up once and it drafts in your voice and remembers your priorities, so less of what it produces needs a rewrite.

It stays private

Your prompts and data stay inside your tenant under enterprise protection. More on that next.

Is my data safe?

This is the first question every leader should ask. Here is the honest answer, before you type a single prompt.



The short version

- ✓ **Your data stays in your tenant.** Copilot Premium runs inside your Microsoft 365 boundary, protected by the same enterprise encryption and access controls as the rest of your data.
- ✓ **It is not used to train models.** Your prompts, your documents, and Copilot's responses are not used to train the foundation models.
- ✓ **It only sees what you can see.** Copilot respects your existing permissions. It cannot surface a file you do not already have access to.
- ✓ **You have controls and an audit trail.** Purview gives your IT and compliance teams visibility, data-loss-prevention policies, and audit logs across Copilot activity.

Copilot works on your real work, not the open internet, and your work never leaves your tenant.

For the regulated-industry deep dive on what happens when web search is involved and what your BAA does and does not cover, see [Copilot Chat, HIPAA & Web Search](#) in the resource library.

Where to find Copilot

The single most common reason new users stall: they can't find it. Here is every door in.

The Copilot app (your front door)

Open the Copilot icon in Teams or on your taskbar, or go to m365.cloud.microsoft. This is the everything box: ask it anything about your work.

Inside each Office app

Look for the Copilot button in the ribbon of Outlook, Word, Excel, and PowerPoint. It works on the document or email in front of you.

In your meetings

In Teams meetings, Copilot can recap what was said, list decisions, and pull action items, even if you joined late.

On your phone

The Microsoft 365 Copilot mobile app puts the same assistant in your pocket for between-meeting moments.

Bookmark two links: the [Copilot app](#) and the [Copilot Prompt Gallery](#) for ready-made prompts by role.

Talk to Copilot, especially on your phone

The fastest-growing way executives use Copilot Premium isn't typing. It's talking.

Open the Copilot app on your phone, tap the voice button, and just ask. Between meetings, in the car, or walking to the next thing, you can catch up on your Teams chats, get a quick briefing, or think a decision out loud and have Copilot answer back. It works on the desktop too, but voice on mobile is where a lot of leaders are living right now.

Out loud: What are my three most important emails today, and what does each one need from me?

Out loud: Catch me up on my Teams chats from this afternoon. What did I miss and what needs a reply?

Your first 5-minute win

Don't try to learn Copilot. Give it one job today.

Open the Copilot app and paste one of these. Use real names from your world. You will have a useful answer in under a minute.

Catch up fast

Try: Catch me up on my email thread with [name] about [topic]. Summarize what was decided and tell me what I still owe them.

Clear the inbox

Try: What are the most important emails I received in the last 24 hours that need my response? Group them by urgency and keep it short.

Walk in ready

Try: Prepare me for my next meeting. Summarize recent emails and documents with the attendees and what we agreed last time.

Start with one win, not forty features.

The prompt formula

A good prompt has four parts. You already do this when you delegate to a person.

- ✓ **Goal:** what you want. "Draft a reply," "summarize this," "find the risks."
- ✓ **Context:** who it's for and why. "For my board," "for a non-technical audience."
- ✓ **Source:** what to use. "From this thread," "using the attached document," "based on last week's meeting."
- ✓ **Format:** how you want it back. "One page," "five bullets," "a short email in my tone."

Weak prompt, weak answer:

Write something about the vendor meeting.

Same request, with the four parts:

Better: Draft a short update for my leadership team (**goal + context**) from the notes of yesterday's vendor meeting (**source**). Plain language, five bullets, decisions and next steps only (**format**).

Don't learn the tool. Give it a job, the way you'd brief a sharp assistant.

Copilot as your chief of staff

The gap between a helpful tool and a trusted operator is personalization.
Spend 15 minutes here and everything after gets better.

- 1 Tell it who you are.** Give Copilot a short profile: your role, your priorities, how you like things written, what you care about. Start from the [Copilot Personalization guide](#).
- 2 Let it remember.** Copilot Memory keeps your context so you don't repeat yourself. See [Copilot Memory](#) for what's worth saving.
- 3 Give it a standing job.** Build a reusable agent that protects your time and thinks at your altitude. The [Chief of Staff agent](#) walks you through it in about 15 minutes, with templates.
- 4 Put it on a schedule.** Scheduled prompts run on their own. Set one up so every weekday morning Copilot sends you a brief of what needs your attention, before you open your laptop. That is the chief-of-staff move: it comes to you.

Agents worth building first

[Chief of Staff](#)

Protects your time, thinks at your altitude, and sounds like you. Comes with two Word templates and a copy-paste setup.

[BossBuddy](#)

A virtual AI manager for strategy and career-level thinking. Helps you clarify your impact and see the bigger picture.

[Taskmaster](#)

Tracks what needs attention, pulls action items, and gives strategic guidance to move work forward.

[Impact Check](#)

Summarizes and links across your Microsoft 365 activity so you can see your real influence on projects and people.

Save the prompts that work

Once you find prompts you use often, save them in the [Copilot Prompt Gallery](#) so they are one click away instead of retyped each time. Your team can publish a shared set everyone reuses, and your assistant can keep the library current so your best prompts spread across the office.

By app: where the time comes back

The same assistant, tuned to the document in front of you. Real executive use cases, with prompts to steal.

Outlook, your inbox on your terms

Triage the morning, summarize a long thread in seconds, draft replies in your tone, and prep for meetings without digging. Coaching even reviews a draft's tone before you hit send.

Try: Summarize this thread and draft a reply that agrees to the timeline but asks for the budget in writing. Keep my tone direct and warm.

[Copilot in Outlook Prompt Pack](#): inbox triage, long-thread summaries, drafting, tone control, and meeting prep.

Word, from blank page to board-ready

Draft a document from your own files, rewrite anything for a specific audience, and compress a 20-page report into a one-page summary that a busy board will actually read.

Try: Draft a one-page board update from these three documents. Plain language for a non-technical audience, decisions and risks up front.

Excel, answers without the formulas

Point Copilot at a spreadsheet and ask what's happening in plain English. It surfaces trends, flags what looks off, and writes the formula so you don't have to. Agent Mode goes further for real analysis.

Try: Analyze this spreadsheet. What are the three trends I should care about, and what looks off or inconsistent?

[Claude in Copilot with Agent Mode for Excel](#): a hands-on walkthrough with demo data and prompts.

PowerPoint, a deck from what you already wrote

Turn a document into a first-draft deck, summarize a long presentation to five slides, or rewrite a cluttered slide so it lands with executives.

Try: Create a five-slide executive summary from this document. One idea per slide, plain headlines, no jargon.

Teams, never walk in behind

Copilot recaps a meeting you missed, catches you up on a busy chat, and turns a discussion into decisions and owners, so you lead the follow-up instead of chasing it. Short on time between meetings, or on the road? Turn a recap into an **audio overview** and listen to what you missed like a short podcast.

Try: Recap this meeting. Give me the decisions, the open questions, and who owns each next step.

Tip: gather a meeting recap and the related documents in a **Copilot Notebook**, then generate an audio overview to catch up hands-free on the drive home.

Perspectives and insights

Where Copilot earns its keep for a leader: a second set of eyes that never gets tired or tells you only what you want to hear.

New lens

Contextual Filter

Read any document through the lens of a specific role and surface only what matters to you.

Pressure test

Devil's Advocate

Surface the three most likely reasons a proposal fails before you walk into the room.

Your voice

Voice Distiller

Mine a year of your communications into a leadership style Copilot can write in.

Read as a role

Try: Read this document as my CFO. Surface only the financial risks and the questions I should be ready to answer.

Before you commit

Try: Pressure-test this plan. Give me the strongest case against it and the one thing most likely to go wrong.

10 Prompts for Executives: a curated set for higher-stakes, strategic workflows.

Two agents that do the heavy thinking

Most prompts hand you an answer. These two do the work behind it, the kind you used to hand an analyst and wait a week for. Point one at a decision, point the other at your numbers, and walk in with the thinking already done.



Researcher

Your strategy analyst

Runs deep, multi-step research across your work and the web, then hands back a structured, cited briefing.

- Combines your documents with the web
- Reasons in steps and shows its sources
- Built for strategy, not quick lookups



Analyst

Your data scientist on demand

Reasons over raw spreadsheets step by step, writes and runs its own analysis code, and returns the insight.

- Works on your raw Excel or CSV data
- Writes and runs live analysis code
- Returns trends, tables, and visuals

RESEARCHER · TRY THIS

Act as my strategy analyst. Research how leading health systems are using AI to improve **[patient access and operational efficiency]**. Ground it in our own board and strategy materials where you can, then add the open web. Give me the three highest-value opportunities, what peer systems did, the risks to watch, and a one-page recommendation I can take to the board.

THEN PAIR IT WITH ANALYST

Analyze this workbook of service-line volumes and time-to-appointment across our sites. Show me where demand and access differ most, flag anything that looks off, and tell me where to focus first.



One place for a big topic: Copilot Notebooks

When one initiative is spread across a dozen files, meetings, and threads, gather them into a Copilot Notebook. Ask questions across everything at once, grounded only in what you added, then turn it into an audio overview and catch up hands-free on the drive home.

Gather it once, ask across all of it, then listen to it like a podcast.

Your first 30 days

Adoption dies without a habit. Four weeks, one focus each. Fifteen minutes a day beats a training marathon.

WEEK 1 · FIND IT

One win a day

Open Copilot each morning. Catch up on a thread, summarize your inbox, prep one meeting. Start from [Start My Day](#).

WEEK 2 · INBOX AND MEETINGS

Run your day through it

Use the [Outlook pack](#) and turn every meeting into [decisions and owners](#).

WEEK 3 · YOUR DOCUMENTS

Word, Excel, PowerPoint

Put Copilot on real work: a report to summarize, a spreadsheet to read, a deck to draft. Small, real tasks.

WEEK 4 · MAKE IT YOURS

Personalize and delegate

Set your [personalization](#), build a [Chief of Staff agent](#), and start using it for perspective.

Fifteen minutes a day for a month turns a tool you have into a habit you trust.

Copilot, not autopilot

Trust it faster by knowing exactly where the line is. Honest expectations prevent week-two disappointment.

- ✓ **It drafts, you decide.** Copilot won't send an email, book a meeting, or make a call you didn't ask for. Your name still goes on the output.
- ✓ **Check the facts that matter.** It can be confidently wrong. For numbers, names, and commitments, verify before you forward.
- ✓ **The output is only as good as the input.** A vague prompt or messy files give vague answers. The four-part formula fixes most of this.
- ✓ **It is getting better fast.** Capabilities change month to month. If something felt limited in the spring, it is worth another look.

Copilot writes the first draft. You still sign your name to it.

If you work through an assistant

Most executives don't work alone. Copilot multiplies a great EA, it doesn't replace one.

Your assistant can run Copilot on the shared work you already trust them with: triaging your inbox, prepping your briefings, turning meetings into follow-ups, and drafting in a voice you've agreed on. Bring them into this from day one. Share your personalization profile so what they produce sounds like you, and let them own the daily prep so you get the summary, not the search.

A good first move

Have your assistant set up the [Start My Day](#) and [meeting-to-actions](#) prompts, then hand you the output each morning.

The resource library

Everything linked in this guide, in one place. All from the field-tested Copilot Playground.

Start here

Getting Started with Copilot

Learn the ropes and your first prompts

10 Starter Copilot Chat Prompts

Ten practical prompts ready to run

The Copilot app

m365.cloud.microsoft, your front door

Copilot Prompt Gallery

Browse Microsoft's prompts by role and task

Make it yours

Copilot Personalization

Customize how Copilot responds to you

Copilot Memory

What's worth having it remember

Leadership Style & Voice Distiller

Build your personal voice reference

Copywriting Precision & Tone

Refine any writing in your own voice

Chief of staff agents

Chief of Staff

Build your own in about 15 minutes

BossBuddy

A virtual AI manager for strategy

Taskmaster

Tracks what needs your attention

Impact Check

See your influence across M365

Executive and perspective

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Pressure-test before the room

Meeting Notes to Actions

Decisions and owners in one shot

By app and daily workflow

[Copilot in Outlook Prompt Pack](#)

Triage, summaries, drafting, tone

[Start My Day](#)

A morning overview to run daily

[Agent Mode for Excel](#)

Hands-on walkthrough with demo data

[Future Meeting Catch-Up](#)

Prep for meetings before they happen

For your IT and security team

[Copilot Chat, HIPAA & Web Search](#)

What crosses the tenant boundary

[The full Copilot Playground](#)

Agents, prompts, and video guides

[Copilot Governance, Getting Started](#)

Access, DLP, labeling, cost controls

[Copilot Prompt Gallery](#)

Official Microsoft prompts you can browse

YOU ARE NOT DOING THIS ALONE

Get help

The fastest path from licensed to fluent is a person. That's my job.



Michael Goad

Copilot Solution Engineer · Microsoft

Bring me your team and I'll run a live 45-minute working session: we'll set up personalization, build a Chief of Staff agent, and get each leader their first real win on their own work.

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An Executive Guide to Microsoft 365 Copilot Premium · Resources from the Copilot Playground
(github.com/heyitsgoad/copilot-playground)